

Quality with consumables

The quality of your photo printer may be excellent, but your investment can go right down the drain if the consumables you use are not up to the mark. If you are stingy in choosing the ink cartridge and the paper that you want the prints on, you will have to be prepared for poorer quality. Here are some tips to make sure you don't land up in a difficult situation:

Paper type

Make sure that the paper quality you have is the best available for your particular application. If you want a regular photo print, you can use two types of paper—glossy or matte. Both have their disadvantages. Glossy paper is susceptible to accidental fingerprints after you get a print done; matte paper will not offer the finish that glossy paper does. It's up to you to decide. Regular matte paper starts at around Rs 12 and goes up to Rs 100, depending on brand and company. If you order it in bulk, a price reduction is possible. On the other hand, regular glossy paper starts at Rs 25 and can go up to Rs 150, depending on the quality and thickness.

Paper quality

Check for the thickness of the paper and the whiteness. Whiter backgrounds will result in a high-contrast image print, which improves the overall quality of the image. Thickness is important—it can make or mar the image. Some papers may be too thick for the kind of printing you do, while other papers may be so thin that the ink permeates through to the other side. This type of paper is especially risky for dye-sublimation printers, which use heat to print different colour densities on paper. Thick papers, on the other hand, can cause the pick-up mechanism to jam, especially when you want to print cards or calendars.

Models available				
Vendor	Model	Technology	Price	Application
Hewlett-Packard	HP PS 7260	Inkjet	Rs 6,499	4 x 6 prints, borderless printing. Targeted towards the home segment.
	HP PS 130	Inkjet	Rs 8,999	4 x 6 prints, borderless printing. Support for memory cards. Home segment.
	HP PS 7960	Inkjet	Rs 16,999	4 x 6 prints, borderless printing. Support for memory cards. Home/SoHo segment.
Canon	I905D	Bubble Jet	Rs 21,995	4 x 6 prints, borderless printing. Support for memory cards and PictBridge. SoHo segment.
	I990	Bubble Jet	Rs 25,995	4 x 6 prints, borderless printing. Support for memory cards and PictBridge. SoHo segment.
Epson	CP-300	Dye-sublimation	Rs 16,995	Portable printer, only for photo printing. 4 x 6 prints. Targeted towards the home user.
	Photo830	Inkjet	Rs 7,500	4 x 6 prints, borderless printing. Support for memory cards. Home segment.
	Photo R310	Inkjet	Rs 13,495	4 x 6 prints, borderless printing. Memory cards and PictBridge. Home/SoHo segment.
	Photo 2100	Inkjet	Rs 54,900	Photo printing only. A3+, A3, borderless printing. SoHo/Professional segment.

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